MILITARY SPECIFICATION

# CARTRIDGE CASE LOADING ASSEMBLY, M118 LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

This specification is approved for use by the U.S. Army Armament Research and Development Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the loading, assembling and packing for one type of case, cartridge designated as Cartridge Case Loading Assembly, M118 for use in various 40MM Ammunition.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. - The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of
MIL-P-20444 - Primer, M42
MIL-A-48078 - Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specifications For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes (ABC-STD-105)

FSC: 1310

**Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, Attn. DRDAR-QA, Dover, New Jersey 07801 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.**

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DRAWINGS (See 6.7)

US ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT COMMAND

8844609 - Cartridge Case Loading Assembly, M118
8887976 - Box, Packing, Ammunition For Case, Cartridge, 40MM, M118 Primed, with Ignition Charge
8887977 - Box, Packing, Ammunition, For Case, Cartridge, 40MM, M118 Primed, with Ignition Charge

2.2 Other publications. - The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS

TITLE 49 - Transportation, Parts 100-199

(The Code of Federal Regulations is available from the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402. Orders should specify, "49 CFR 100-199 (latest revision)").

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. - Materials shall be in accordance with the applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Assembly. - The assembly shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (Dwg.) 8844609, and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Functioning (See 6.5). - The case, cartridge shall function and comply with the following requirements.

3.3.1 Mean Velocity. - The projectile shall have a mean velocity of 247 ± 7 feet-per-second.



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3.3.2 Firing. - There shall be no primer blow back as evidenced by perforation of the cup and extrustion of the primer around firing pin causing difficulty in opening weapon.

3.4 Production control check on loaded M118 cartridge case. - There shall be no evidence of any of the following:

a. Primer malfunction.
b. Any primer blows back as evidenced by perforation of of the cup and extrusion of the firing pin causing difficulty in opening weapon.
c. Case cartridge cannot be ejected from the launcher by spring operation of the extractor.
d. Case cartridge cannot be ejected from the launcher by hand operation of the extractor.

When the propellant serial lot changes, the requirements of b, c, and d, do not apply.

3.5 Primer functioning. - The primer shall function without evidence of squibbing or hangfire. Paragraph 6.6 of Military Specification MIL-P-20444, Amendment 3 contains definitions of functioning failures.

3.6 First article inspection. - This specification contains technical provisions for first article inspection. Requirements for the submission of first article samples by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

3.7 Workmanship. - All parts and assemblies shall be fabricated, loaded and assembled in a thorough, workmanlike manner. They shall be free of burrs, sharp edges, cracks, dirt, grease, rust, and other foreign matter. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any parts, nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agents. Exterior surface coatings shall be continuous; however, a few light scratches not exposing base material may be permitted. All required marking and stamping shall be neat and sharply defined.

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection and standard quality assurance provisions. - Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are hereby made a part of this specification.



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4.2 Classification of inspections. - The following type of inspection shall be conducted on this item:

a. First Article Inspection
b. Quality Conformance Inspection.

4.3 First article inspection. -

4.3.1 Submission. - The contractor shall submit a first article sample as designated by the Contracting Officer for evaluation in accordance with the provisions of 4.3.2. Prior to submission, the sample shall be inspected by the contractor to the degree necessary to assure that it conforms to the requirements of the contract. The first article sample shall consist of the following items in sample quantities as indicated:

| Part Description | Drawing | Quantity |
|---|---|---|
| Cartridge Case Loading Assembly M118 | 8844609 | 300 |

4.3.2 Inspections to be performed. - See MIL-A-48078 and Table 1 specified herin.

4.3.3 Rejection. - The first article quantity shall be rejected if any of the following occur:

a. Any primer blow back (as evidenced by perforation of the cup and extrusion of the primer around firing pin causing difficulty in opening weapon).
b. Mean velocity fails to meet the applicable requirement.
c. Primer misfires.
d. Thirty (30) or more cartridge cases cannot be ejected from the launcher by spring operation of the extractor.
e. One (1) or more cartridges cases cannot be ejected from the launcher by hand operation of the extractor.



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TABLE I - FIRST ARTICLE INSPECTION

**CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS** MIL-C-63133(AR)

| PARAGRAPH | TITLE | SHEET 1 OF 1 | DRAWING NUMBER |
|---|---|---|---|
| | Cartridge Case Loading Assembly, M118 | | See Below |
| | | | NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY |

| CATEGORY | EXAMINATION OR TEST | NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS | AQL OR 100% | REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH | PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Cartridge case loading assembly (Dwg. 8844609) | | | | |
| | Examination for defects | 300 | | 3.2 | 4.4.2.2 |
| | Functioning | 300 | * | 3.3 | 4.5.8 |

NOTES: *See 4.3.3

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection. -

4.4.1 Inspection lot formation. - Inspection lots shall comply with the lot formation provisions of MIL-A-48078. In addition, inspection lots of cartridge case loading assemblies shall contain:

a. Primers of one serial lot number from one manufacturer.
b. Cartridge case metal parts from one interfix lot number from one manufacturer.
c. Propellant from one serial lot number from one manufacturer.

4.4.2 Examination. - See MIL-A-48078.

a. Sampling plans. - Unless otherwise specified in the Classification of Defects and Test Tables, sampling plans for major and minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level II.



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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

MIL-C-63133(AR)

## CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

| PARAGRAPH | TITLE | | SHEET | DRAWING NUMBER |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4.4.2.1 | Cartridge Case Loading Assembly, prior to assembling base plug and primer | | 1 OF 1 | 8844609 |
| | | | | NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY |

| CATEGORY | EXAMINATION OR TEST | NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS | AQL OR 100% | REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH | PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Critical | | | | | |
| 1 | Powder charge cup missing | | 100% | 3.2 | Gage |
| 2 | Spilled powder from cartridge case | | 100% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 3 | Propellant charge weight obviously incorrect (See 6.6) | | 100% | 3.2 | Visual |
| Major | | | | | |
| 101 | Propellant charge weight obviously incorrect (See 6.6) | | 100% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 102 | Propellant weight of cartridge case | | | 3.2 | 4.5.3 |
| 103 | Propellant weight of cartridge case (alternate method) | | | 3.2 | 4.5.4 |
| 104 | Security of crimp of base plug | | | 3.2 | 4.5.7 |

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

## CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-63133(AR)

| PARAGRAPH | TITLE | | SHEET 1 OF 1 | | DRAWING NUMBER |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4.4.2.2 | Cartridge Case Loading Assembly | | | | 8844609 |
| | | | | | NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY |
| CATEGORY | EXAMINATION OR TEST | NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS | AQL OR 100% | REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH | PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD |
| Critical | | | | | |
| 1 | Primer above flush with respect to base of case | | 100% | 3.2 | Gage |
| Special | | | | | |
| a. | Vent hole blocked or missing (prior to case loading) | | 100% | 3.2 | Automatic Gage or Visual/Equipment |
| Major A | | | | | |
| 101 | Base plug above flush | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Gage |
| 102 | Depth to base plug, maximum (max) | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Gage |
| 103 | Primer above flush or more than -005 below with respect to base plug | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Gage |
| 104 | Primer damaged | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 105 | Production control check on loaded cases | | | 3.4 | 4.5.5 |
| 106 | Functioning | | | 3.3 | 4.5.8 |
| Minor | | | | | |
| 201 | Excessive varnish on exterior surface of primer | | 0.65% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 202 | Marking misleading or unidentifiable | | 0.65% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 203 | Evidence of poor workmanship | | 0.65% | 3.6 | Visual |

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

## CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-63133(AR)

| PARAGRAPH | TITLE | | SHEET 1 OF 1 | | DRAWING NUMBER |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4.4.2.3 | Box, fiber prior to sealing | | | | 8887976 |
| | | | | | NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY |
| CATEGORY | EXAMINATION OR TEST | NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS | AQL OR 100% | REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH | PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD |
| Critical | None defined | | | | |
| Major A | None defined | | | | |
| 101 | Number of cartridge case assemblies incorrect | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 102 | Insufficient fillers | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 103 | Separator missing | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 104 | Cartridge case assembly facing wrong way | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Viusal |
| Minor | None defined | | | | |

NOTES:





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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

# CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-63133(AR)

| PARAGRAPH | TITLE | SHEET | DRAWING NUMBER |
|---|---|---|---|
| 4.4.2.4 | Box, fiber prior to sealing bag | 1 OF 1 | 8887976 |
| | | | NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY |

| CATEGORY | EXAMINATION OR TEST | NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS | AQL OR 100% | REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH | PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Critical | None defined | | | | |
| Major | | | | | |
| 101 | Container damaged | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 102 | Corners not blunted | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 103 | Heat seal test of packing seals | (a) | (a) | 3.2 | 4.5.3 |
| Minor | | | | | |
| 201 | Contents loose | | 0.65% | 3.2 | Manual |
| 202 | Label or marking missing or unidentifiable | | 0.65% | 3.2 | Visual |

NOTES:

(a) Sampling and rejectionshall be in accordance with MIL-P-116.

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**CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS**

MIL-C-63133(AR)

| PARAGRAPH | TITLE | | SHEET 1 OF 1 | | DRAWING NUMBER |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4.4.2.5 | Wooden box, prior to sealing | | | | 8887977<br>NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY |
| CATEGORY | EXAMINATION OR TEST | NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS | AQL OR 100% | REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH | PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD |
| Critical | None defined | | | | |
| Major | | | | | |
| 101 | Number of fiber boxes incorrect | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 102 | Marking of bag misleading or unidentifiable | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 103 | Bag torn or perforated | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 104 | Bag improperly sealed | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| Minor | None defined | | | | |

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

## CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

| PARAGRAPH | TITLE | SHEET 1 OF 1 | DRAWING NUMBER |
|---|---|---|---|
| 4.4.2.6 | Wooden box, packing | | 8887977 |
| | | | NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY — |

| CATEGORY | EXAMINATION OR TEST | NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS | AQL OR 100% | REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH | PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Critical | None defined | | | | |
| Major | | | | | |
| 101 | Box damaged | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 102 | Strapping missing or incorrect | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| 103 | Top improperly assembled | | 0.40% | 3.2 | Visual |
| Minor | | | | | |
| 201 | Content loose | | 0.65% | 3.2 | Manual |
| 202 | Marking misleading or unidentifiable | | 0.65% | 3.2 | Visual |

NOTES:

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4.4.3 Testing. - Testing is described in the First Article and Quality Conformance Inspection Tables.

4.4.4 Inspection Equipment. - The inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein is described in the Paragraph Reference/Inspection Method column in the tables starting with Paragraph 4.4.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See Section 6 of MIL-A-48078 and 6.2 herein.

4.5 Test methods and procedures. -

4.5.1 Check test for deterioration of primers (See M IL-P-20444. - If the total time between original acceptance of any lot and the assembly of the lot into the cartridge exceeds two years, or if the primers have been subjected to adverse conditons, however brief, at any time since previous tests, the primer lot shall be subjected to and must satisfactorily pass, the check test for deterioration specified in MIL-P-20444, immediately before the primer lot is assembled into the cartridge. This test shall be performed by the contractor on primers selected by the Government Inspector at the facility assembling the primers into the cartridge (See 6.3).

4.5.2 Holding fixture vent check. - The cartridge case holding fixture used in the base plug insertion operation shall have its air vents checked hourly for any obstruction. If a vent is found to be closed or clogged, the vent shall be cleared and the previous hour's production shall be x-rayed 100 percent to ensure that the propellant charge cups have not been damaged. Cartridge cases found to have damaged charge cups shall be classed defective and removed from the lot.

4.5.3 Propellant weight of cartridge case. - The propellant weight shall be determined and then check weighed 100 percent. The check weighing shall be accomplished independently or the original weighing or determination, using a different balance from that used to make the original weighing and if performed manually, shall be performed by another operator. Any charge which fails to comply with the requirement specified on Dwg. 8844609 shall be classified defective and removed from the lot. (See Para. 4.4.2.1).



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4.5.4 Propellant weight of cartridge case, alternate method. - At the start of production, three hundred eighty (380) consecutive samples per station per machine shall be selected and weighed 100 percent. All samples shall comply with the drawing requirement, five (5) samples, per station, per every two (2) hours production shall be selected and the average weight of the five (5) samples must meet the assessed mean propellant weight within ± 4 milligrams. If the average weight fails the requirement, correction shall be made and three hundred eighty (380) consecutive samples weighed from that station. If all meet the applicable requirement, the sampling every two (2) hours will be resumed.

4.5.5 Production control check on loaded M118 cartridge case. - Ten (10) loaded M118 cases shall be randomly selected from every four (4) hours production from each primer assembly machine. The loaded M118 cases produced by each primer assembly shall be kept segregated and identified. They shall not be used until this test has been performed. The loaded M118 cartridge case shall be fired from an approved launcher placed on an approved mount. Observation shall be made from primer functioning. If any sample fails to comply with the applicable requirement, the four (4) hours production represented by the sample shall be rejected. Parts so tested shall not be returned to the lot.

NOTE: No projectile is required for this test.

4.5.6 Primer functioning. - Sampling shall be in accordance with paragraph 4.2.3.2.2 of MIL-P-20444, except that the sample size shall be eight hundred (800) primers from each lot. Each primer of the 800 samples shall be tested as specified in Paragraph 4.3.2.2 of MIL-P-20444. If one or more primers fail to comply with the applicable requirement, the lot of primers shall not be used and disposition requested. Primers not originally purchased to this requirement shall be tested for the requirement of Paragraph 3.5.

4.5.7 Security of crimp of base plug on cartridge case assembly. - Twenty (20) each of cartridge case, base plug and powder charge cup less propellant shall be selected from each lot and subjected to this test. The assembly shall be placed



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in an approved fixture and the minimum unseating force specified on the applicable drawing shall be applied. If the average unseating force fails to comply with the drawing requirement, or one (1) value is below 2000 lbs., the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.8 Functioning. - The loaded cartridge case assembly shall be observed for any evidence of failure to comply with the requirements as classified in Table 1. This test applies only when the propellant serial lot changes.

TABLE 1

| DEFECT | CLASSIFICATION |
|---|---|
| Any primer blows back (as evidenced by perforation of the cup and extrusion of the firing pin causing difficulty in opening weapon) | Critical |
| Primer misfire | Major |
| Mean velocity fails to meet the applicable requirement. | Major |
| Case, cartridge cannot be ejected from the launcher by spring operation of the extractor. | Major |
| Case, cartridge cannot be ejected from the launcher by hand operation of the extractor. | Major |

4.5.8.1 The Government Inspector shall select one hundred and twenty-five (125) loaded cartridge case assemblies from each lot and subjected to this test. The lot shall be rejected if a critical defect occurs, two (2) or more primers misfire, ten (10) or more case cartridges cannot be rejected from the launcher by spring operation of the extractor, or one (1) or more case cartridges cannot be ejected from the launcher by hand operation of the extractor. The test shall be performed at a Government owned proving ground. The sample loaded cartridge case assembly shall be assembled (using the same method as specified in NOTE 2 of Dwg. 9207987) to an inert projectile and fired from an approved launcher placed on an approved mount to impact at 100 meters minimum from the launcher on a six inch thick loose gravel pad. The gravel used shall have a 1/2 inch maximum size. The velocity shall be measured at 20 feet from the muzzle of the launcher using two sets of screens, each set



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of screens having an electronic counter. One set of screens shall be placed 14 and 26 feet from the launcher and the other set 15 and 25 feet from the launcer. NOTE: To insure that the chronographs are read properly, the ratio of the two times shall not differ form 1,200 by more than plus or minus 0.005. If the ratio differs from 1,200 by more than plus or minus 0.0005, the results shall be discarded and another round fired in its place. Observation shall be made and results recorded for functioning and mean velocity. This test applies only when the propellant serial lot changes.

4.5.9 Heat seal test and packing seals. - The test shall be performed in accordance with MIL-P-116. Seals so tested shall not be returned to the lot.

5. PACKAGING.

5.1 Preservation and packaging. -

5.1.1 Level B. - The cartridge case loading assembly shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with Dwg. 8887976.

5.2 Packing. -

5.2.1 Level B. - The cartridge case loading assembly preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed for shipment in accordance with Dwg. 8887977.

5.3 Marking. - Marking shall be in accordance with Dwgs. 8887976, 8887977 and Interstate Commerce Commision Code of Federal Regulations 49 CFR 100-199.

5.4 Shipping. - When shipments from more than one lot are shipped as a carload, each lot shall be kept separate, and the division between lots clearly indicated to prevent mixing of the lots in transit.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. - The component covered by this specification is intended for use in various 40MM ammuniton.



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6.2 Submission of inspection equipment designs for approval. - See MIL-A-48078. Submit equipment designs as required, to Commander, ARRADCOM, Attn: DRDAR-QAA-I, Dover, New Jersey 07801.

6.3 Cost of check test. - The contracting officer will arrange for the contractor to be reimbursed for the expense incurred in the performance of the check test for deterioration of the primer assemblies. The tests shall be conducted at Government expense without cost to the contractor who loaded the primer assemblies, or to the contractor assmebling the primer assemblies into the cartridge case; and shall not constitute a basis for rejection against either contractor except where deterioration has occurred as a direct result of carlessness in handling, storage, etc., permitted while the primer assembly lot was under the jurisdication of either contractor.

6.4 Submission of results of contractor-conducted examinations and tests. - Unless otherwise specified by the Contracting Officer, the contractor shall forward requested records of examinations or tests to Commander, ARRADCOM, Attn: DRDAR-QAA-Q.

6.5 When the contractor for loading the cartridge case is also the contractor for loading the complete cartridge used therewith, the functioning tests may be combined upon approval by the Contracting Officer.

6.6 If any cartridge case, prior to insertion of the base plug and primer, is suspected of containing an underweight or overweight propellant charge, based on visual inspection, it will be removed from the lot and weighed on suitable scales. Any cartridge case found with less than 75 percent or more than 125 percent of the assessed propellant load will be classified as a critical defect and removed from the lot. Any cartridge case found to have a propellant weight out of drawing tolerance but within ± 25 percent of the assessed propellant load will be classified as a major defect and removed from the lot.

6.7 Drawings. - Drawings listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading U.S. Army Armament Research



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and Development Command (ARRADCOM) may also include drawings prepared by, and identified as, Edgewood Arsenal, Frankford Arsenal, Rock Island Arsenal, or Picatinny Arsenal drawings. Technical data origianlly prepared by these activities are now under the cognizance of ARRADCOM.

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Army- AR

Project Number: 1310-A-103

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